smarter BALANCED

Answer Key Printout

Total Items: 32

15-March-2026

Item ID	Grade	Subject	Answer Key	Claim	Target	CCSS	DOK	Type
182942	5	ELA	D	2	9	5.L.2	1	MC
27809	5	ELA	See appended rubric	2	3	5.W.2b	3	SA
93185	5	ELA	Student receives one point by selecting: • embarrassed AND • astonishment	2	8	5.W.2d	2	HTQ
96054	5	ELA	C	2	9	5.L.1	1	MC
182960	5	ELA	C	2	6	5.W.1d	2	MC
23401	5	ELA	C	2	9	L.5.1b	1	MC
23399	5	ELA	Student receives **one** point for selecting: • I was wearing old jeans and a tattered white T-shirt. AND • My grandmother beamed with delight when she heard the taxi door slam.	2	2	5.W.3a	2	HTQ
61136	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	4	5.W.9	3	SA
61138	5	ELA	B,F	4	2	5.RI.7	3	MS
54141	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	2	5.RI.9	3	SA
54683	5	ELA	See appended rubric	2	2	5.W.3a	4	WER
182951	5	ELA	Mia frowned and replied, “If I had put my book somewhere else, I would not have forget it!”	2	9	5.L.1b	1	HTQ

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26451	5	ELA	The student receives **one** point for selecting: • so AND • Instead	2	8	5.W.3d	2	HTQ
22835	5	ELA	D,E	2	8	5.W.2d	1	MS
26831	5	ELA	E,F	2	8	5.W.3d	2	MS
41674	5	ELA	E,F	2	8	5.L.6	2	MS
23403	5	ELA	Student receives **one** point for selecting: • He introduced himself as our new homeroom teacher Mr. Johnson. AND • After that, he passed out copies of a story he likes called The Good Game.	2	9	L.5.2d	1	HTQ
182646	5	ELA	People who own businesses have to consider the well-being of all of their guests.: Source #3: New Service Animal Rules Being smart and able to handle small objects makes certain animals more appropriate than other animals to assist people who have a disability.: Source #1: Monkey Helpers, Source #2: Animals Helping People	4	4	5.W.8	3	MI
182648	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	3	W.5.9	4	SA
182649	5	ELA	See appended rubric	2	7	5.W.1b	4	WER
26827	5	ELA	D	2	8	5.L.6	1	MC
182958	5	ELA	Student receives one point by selecting: • Some people like blankets better than quilts. AND • Sometimes, they had to quit early because they ran out of candles.	2	3	5.W.2b	2	HTQ
41664	5	ELA	C	2	8	5.W.2d	2	MC

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35762	5	ELA	C	2	8	5.W.3d	2	MC
26465	5	ELA	A	2	9	5.L.2a	1	MC
123746	5	ELA	D	2	1	5.W.3b	1	MC
103996	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	2	5.W.8	3	SA
103998	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	3	5.W.9a	4	SA
104002	5	ELA	See appended rubric	2	4	5.W.2a	4	WER
182938	5	ELA	C,F	2	8	5.W.3d	1	MS
60337	5	ELA	C	2	8	5.W.3d	1	MC
22779	5	ELA	Student receives **one** point for selecting: • obtained AND • country	2	8	5.L.6	1	HTQ

PT : Performance Task : If you selected a Performance Task item, all items in that Performance Task are included below even if only one item was selected (e.g., Multiple Choice, Short Answer, Extended Response, etc.). Performance Task items are indicated with "PT" next to the item ID number.

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Appended Rubric :

#27809

Points	Description
2	The response: • develops adequate supporting points/ideas/reasons/details and/or evidence from the student notes • does more than list supporting details or ideas • adequately elaborates ideas/reasons using precise words/language
1	The response: • provides mostly general and/or limited supporting points/ideas/reasons/details and/or evidence (which may be extraneous or loosely related) from the student notes • lists supporting details or ideas with limited elaboration/evidence • partially elaborates ideas/reasons using general words/language
0	The response: • provides minimal or no supporting points/ideas/reasons/details and/or evidence from the student notes • provides supporting points/ideas/reasons/details and/or evidence that may be unclear, repetitive, incorrect, contradictory to, or interfere with the meaning of the text • provides no appropriate elaboration and/or may use poor word choice for audience and purpose

#61136

Points	Description

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2	Response is an evidence-based explanation of why whales use different types of sounds supported by two reasons/examples from different sources. Student identifies the source for each reason/example. Responses may include (but are not limited to): Source #2 (Swimming with the Pod) • Whales use sounds like screeches and whistles to socialize and play. • Whales use the echo of their clicking sounds to tell what is around them. • Whales use calls to stay in touch as they hunt for food. Source #3 (How Humpbacks Go Fishing) • Whales make loud calls to try to chase away other whales. • Whales make trumpet like calls to talk to each other when they work together to hunt fish.
1	Response does not provide an evidence-based explanation of why whales use different types of sounds but does identify at least one reason/example from a single source that tells why whales use different types of sounds. Student identifies the source. **OR** Response is an evidence-based explanation of why whales use different types of sounds supported by at least one reason/example from a single source. Student identifies the source. **OR** Response is an evidence-based explanation of why whales use different types of sounds supported by two reasons/examples from different sources. Student does not identify the source for each reason/example. Scoring Note: Score point 1 encompasses partially correct responses.
0	Response is an explanation that is incorrect, irrelevant, or insufficient.

#54141

Points	Description

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2	Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides two pieces of evidence from different sources that support this idea and that explains how each example supports the idea. Student cites the source for each example. Responses may include (but are not limited to): Source #2 (Swimming with the Pod) • The mother whale kept the young whale safe. • The mother whale probably helped the baby whale to the surface when he was first born to take his first breath. • The pod may help injured whales come up to the surface for air. • The whales use sounds in the pods to help each other hunt for food. Source #3 (How Humpbacks Go Fishing) • Humpback whales form a circle of bubbles to catch fish. • Some whales chase the fish into the circle of bubbles. • The whales use trumpet like sounds and wave their flippers to talk to each other while catching the fish. • The whales jump up at the same time so they all catch fish together.
1	Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides two pieces of evidence from different sources that support this idea but doesn't explain how each example supports the idea. Student cites the sources. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides two pieces of evidence from a single source that supports this idea and that explains how that example supports the idea. Student cites the source. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides only one piece of evidence from a single source that support this idea and that explains how that example supports the idea. Student cites the source. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides two pieces of evidence from different sources that support this idea and that explains how each example supports the idea. Student does not cite sources.
0	Response is an explanation that is incorrect, irrelevant, or insufficient.

#54683

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Points	Description
4	**Organization/Purpose**: The organization of the narrative, real or imagined, is fully sustained and the focus is clear and maintained throughout: • an effective plot helps to create a sense of unity and completeness • effectively establishes a setting, narrator/characters, and/or point of view* • consistent use of a variety of transitional strategies to clarify the relationships between and among ideas; strong connection between and among ideas • natural, logical sequence of events from beginning to end • effective opening and closure for audience and purpose *point of view begins at grade 7 **Development/Elaboration**: The narrative, real or imagined, provides thorough, effective elaboration using relevant details, dialogue, and/or description: • experiences, characters, setting and/or events are clearly developed • connections to source materials may enhance the narrative • effective use of a variety of narrative techniques that advance the story or illustrate the experience • effective use of sensory, concrete, and figurative language that clearly advances the purpose • effective, appropriate style enhances the narration **Conventions**: N/A

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3	**Organization/Purpose**: The organization of the narrative, real or imagined, is adequately sustained, and the focus is adequate and generally maintained: • an evident plot helps to create a sense of unity and completeness, though there may be minor flaws and some ideas may be loosely connected • adequately establishes a setting, narrator/characters, and/or point of view* • adequate use of a variety of transitional strategies to clarify the relationships between and among ideas • adequate sequence of events from beginning to end • adequate opening and closure for audience and purpose *point of view begins at grade 7 **Development/Elaboration**: The narrative, real or imagined, provides adequate elaboration using details, dialogue, and/or description: • experiences, characters, setting, and/or events are adequately developed • connections to source materials may contribute to the narrative • adequate use of a variety of narrative techniques that generally advance the story or illustrate the experience • adequate use of sensory, concrete, and figurative language that generally advances the purpose • generally appropriate style is evident **Conventions**: N/A

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2	**Organization/Purpose**: The organization of the narrative, real or imagined, is somewhat sustained and may have an uneven focus: • there may be an inconsistent plot, and/or flaws may be evident • unevenly or minimally establishes a setting, narrator/characters, and/or point of view* • uneven use of appropriate transitional strategies and/or little variety • weak or uneven sequence of events • opening and closure, if present, are weak *point of view begins at grade 7 **Development/Elaboration**: The narrative, real or imagined, provides uneven, cursory elaboration using partial and uneven details, dialogue, and/or description: • experiences, characters, setting, and/or events are unevenly developed • connections to source materials may be ineffective, awkward, or vague but do not interfere with the narrative • narrative techniques are uneven and inconsistent • partial or weak use of sensory, concrete, and figurative language that may not advance the purpose • inconsistent or weak attempt to create appropriate style **Conventions**: The response demonstrates an adequate command of conventions: • adequate use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling
1	**Organization/Purpose**: The organization of the narrative, real or imagined, may be maintained but may provide little or no focus:

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	• there is little or no discernible plot or there may just be a series of events • may be brief or there is little to no attempt to establish a setting, narrator/characters, and/or point of view* • few or no appropriate transitional strategies may be evident and may cause confusion • little or no organization of an event sequence; frequent extraneous ideas and/or a major drift may be evident • opening and/or closure may be missing or unsatisfactory *point of view begins at grade 7 **Development/Elaboration**: The narrative, real or imagined, provides minimal elaboration using few or no details, dialogue, and/or description: • experiences, characters, setting, and/or events may be vague, lack clarity, or confusing • connections to source materials, if evident, may detract from the narrative • use of narrative techniques may be minimal, absent, incorrect, or irrelevant • may have little or no use of sensory, concrete, or figurative language; language does not advance and may interfere with the purpose • little or no evidence of appropriate style **Conventions**: The response demonstrates a partial command of conventions: • limited use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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0	**Organization/Purpose**: N/A **Development/Elaboration**: N/A **Conventions**: The response demonstrates little or no command of conventions: • infrequent use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling **NS (No Score)** **Organization/Purpose**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose **Development/Elaboration**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose

#182648

Points	Description

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2	**Key Elements:** Source #1 (Monkey Helpers) • Every day, for three to five years, capuchin monkeys learn new skills. • Days are spent learning how to load a DVD into a player and pushing play, or opening and closing microwave doors. • The monkeys attending Helping Hands receive years of training. • They are trained only to help with tasks that are done at home. • Years before capuchin monkeys report to their first day of school, they have already spent years around humans. • They live with foster families for up to twelve years. • During this time, they are taught how to share a house with humans. They get used to being around pets. They even learn basic tasks like how to take baths. • Capuchin monkeys are coached and trained for up to five years at Helping Hands. • They pick up tools and use them to solve problems. **Rubric:** (2 points) Response is an evidence-based explanation that correctly identifies the most helpful source AND includes two details from that source that support this evaluation and that explain why each detail supports the idea that it is the most helpful source.

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1	(1 point) Response is an evidence-based explanation that correctly identifies the most helpful source AND includes one detail from that source that supports this evaluation and that explains why the detail supports the idea that it is the most helpful source. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that correctly identifies the most helpful source AND includes two details from that source that support this evaluation but does not explain why each detail supports the idea that it is the most helpful source. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that does not identify a source or correctly identify the most helpful source but includes two details from the correct source and that explains why each detail supports the idea that it is the most helpful source.
0	(0 points) Response is an explanation that is incorrect, irrelevant, insufficient, or blank.

#182649

Points	Description

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4	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has a clear and effective organizational structure, creating a sense of unity and completeness. The organization is sustained between and within paragraphs. The response is consistently and purposefully focused: • opinion is introduced, clearly communicated, and the focus is strongly maintained for the purpose and audience • consistent use of a variety of transitional strategies to clarify the relationships between and among ideas • effective introduction and conclusion • logical progression of ideas from beginning to end; strong connections between and among ideas with some syntactic variety **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides thorough and convincing elaboration of the support/evidence for the opinion and supporting idea(s) that includes the effective use of source material. The response clearly and effectively develops ideas, using precise language: • comprehensive evidence (facts and details) from the source material is integrated, relevant, and specific • clear citations or attribution of source material • effective use of a variety of elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is clearly appropriate for the audience and purpose • effective, appropriate style enhances content *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the opinion. **Conventions**: N/A

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3	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has an evident organizational structure and a sense of completeness. Though there may be minor flaws, they do not interfere with the overall coherence. The organization is adequately sustained between and within paragraphs. The response is generally focused: • opinion is clear, and the focus is mostly maintained for the purpose and audience • adequate use of transitional strategies with some variety to clarify relationships between and among ideas • adequate introduction and conclusion • adequate progression of ideas from beginning to end; adequate connections between and among ideas **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides adequate elaboration of the support/evidence for the opinion and supporting idea(s) that includes the use of source material. The response adequately develops ideas, employing a mix of precise with more general language: • adequate evidence (facts and details) from the source material is integrated and relevant, yet may be general • adequate use of citations or attribution to source material • adequate use of some elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is generally appropriate for the audience and purpose • generally appropriate style is evident *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the opinion. **Conventions**: N/A
2	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has an inconsistent organizational structure. Some flaws are evident, and some ideas may be loosely connected. The organization is somewhat sustained between and within paragraphs. The response may have a minor drift in focus:

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	• opinion may be somewhat unclear, or the focus may be insufficiently sustained for the purpose and/or audience • inconsistent use of transitional strategies and/or little variety • introduction or conclusion, if present, may be weak • uneven progression of ideas from beginning to end; and/or formulaic; inconsistent or unclear connections between and among ideas **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides uneven, cursory elaboration of the support/evidence for the opinion and supporting idea(s) that includes partial or uneven use of source material. The response develops ideas unevenly, using simplistic language: • some evidence (facts and details) from the source material may be weakly integrated, imprecise, repetitive, vague, and/or copied • weak use of citations or attribution to source material • weak or uneven use of elaborative techniques*; development may consist primarily of source summary • vocabulary use is uneven or somewhat ineffective for the audience and purpose • inconsistent or weak attempt to create appropriate style *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the opinion. **Conventions**: The response demonstrates an adequate command of conventions: • adequate use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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1	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has little or no discernible organizational structure. The response may be related to the opinion but may provide little or no focus: • opinion may be confusing or ambiguous; response may be too brief or the focus may drift from the purpose and/or audience • few or no transitional strategies are evident • introduction and/or conclusion may be missing • frequent extraneous ideas may be evident; ideas may be randomly ordered or have an unclear progression **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides minimal elaboration of the support/evidence for the opinion and supporting idea(s) that includes little or no use of source material. The response is vague, lacks clarity, or is confusing: • evidence (facts and details) from the source material is minimal, irrelevant, absent, incorrectly used, or predominantly copied • insufficient use of citations or attribution to source material • minimal, if any, use of elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is limited or ineffective for the audience and purpose • little or no evidence of appropriate style *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the opinion. **Conventions**: The response demonstrates a partial command of conventions: • limited use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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0	**Organization/Purpose**: N/A **Evidence/Elaboration**: N/A **Conventions**: The response demonstrates little or no command of conventions: • infrequent use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling **NS (No Score)** **Organization/Purpose**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose **Evidence/Elaboration**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose

#103996

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Points	Description
2	Response is an adequate evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by two details, one from Source #1 and one from Source #3. Student cites the source for each detail. Scoring Note: Score point 1 encompasses partially correct responses. KEY ELEMENTS Source #1 (Do Not Disturb: The Mysteries of Animal Hibernation) • Hibernation allows animals to save energy and make it through the winter when food is hard to find. • Bears make dens and stay in them through the winter. • Bears' heart rates slow down from its usual 40 or 50 beats a minute to 10 or 12; their temperature drops a few degrees; they breathe slowly, just as a person in a deep sleep would do. • Bears eat a lot in the fall to get ready for hibernation. Source #3 (A Barn for Bears) • In the fall bears fatten up on acorns and high-fat foods. • Bears find a den in the winter and make a bed of leaves and brush. • A bear's heart rate and body temperature drop. • The bears don't sleep all winter, but remain in their dens for 3 to 5 months if not disturbed. • Female bears have their cubs while they hibernate.
1	Response is a limited/partial evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by two vague or loosely related details, one from Source #1 and one from Source #3. Student cites the source for each detail. OR Response is an adequate evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by two details from either Source #1 or Source #3. Student cites the source for each detail. OR Response is an adequate evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by one detail from either Source #1 or Source #3. Student cites the source for the detail. OR Response is an adequate evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by two details, one from Source #1 and one from Source #3. Student does not cite the source for each detail.
0	Response is an explanation that is insufficient, incorrect or irrelevant.

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#103998

Points	Description
2	Response is an identification of which source has the most useful information about how hibernation works and an adequate evidence-based explanation of why it has the most useful information about how hibernation works supported by two details from the identified source. Scoring Note: Score point 1 encompasses partially correct responses. KEY ELEMENTS Source #1 (Do Not Disturb: The Mysteries of Animal Hibernation) • Animals save energy by hibernating. • They also avoid needing food or water during a time that food and water is hard to find by hibernating in the winter. • The hypothalamus, a part of the brain, controls hibernation. • The hypothalamus also regulates hunger, thirst, and blood pressure. • Small amounts of blood were taken from hibernating squirrels. This blood was injected into active squirrels in the spring. These squirrels began to hibernate. • Hibernating animals have HIT (hibernation inducement trigger) in their blood. • HIT makes animals prepare to hibernate. • Animals that really hibernate sleep so deeply that it is difficult to wake them. Their body temperature drops significantly, and their heart rate slows as well. • Animals that "in- between" hibernate have a slight drop in body temperature. Their heart rate also slows, but they continue to look for food at times during the winter. • To prepare for hibernation, most animals eat a lot of food. They gain a lot of fat which helps supply them with energy and keeps them warm while they sleep. • Animals that hibernate have a special brown fat across their shoulders and back. This brown fat provides the first burst of energy to the brain, heart, and lungs that signal the animals that hibernation is coming to an end. Source #2 (Do Bears Hibernate?) • Sensors put in five American black bears by scientists from the University of Alaska at Fairbanks showed that bears do hibernate. • The animals were sent to live in fake dens. They settled in for a long sleep. • Their temperature and heart rate dropped. • The rate at which their bodies were burning calories also dropped. Source #3 (A Barn for Bears) • During the fall season, bears eat high-fat foods to fatten up. • They choose a snug den that is dry and protected. • The bear makes a bed of leaves and brush to sleep on. • The heart rate of the bear slows down and its body temperature drops. • The bear does not really sleep all winter, but it usually doesn't leave its den for the next three to five months. • Hibernating keeps each bear in one place for the winter.

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1	Response is an identification of which source has the most useful information about how hibernation works and a limited or partial evidence-based explanation of why it has the most useful information about how hibernation works, supported by two vague or loosely related details from the identified source. OR Response is an identification of which source has the most useful information about how hibernation works and an adequate evidence-based explanation of why it has the most useful information about how hibernation works, supported by one detail from the identified source.
0	Response is an explanation that is insufficient, incorrect or irrelevant. Just identifying the source is insufficient.

#104002

Points	Description

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4	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has a clear and effective organizational structure, creating a sense of unity and completeness. The organization is sustained between and within paragraphs. The response is consistently and purposefully focused: • controlling/main idea of a topic is clearly communicated, and the focus is strongly maintained for the purpose and audience • consistent use of a variety of transitional strategies to clarify the relationships between and among ideas • effective introduction and conclusion • logical progression of ideas from beginning to end; strong connections between and among ideas with some syntactic variety **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides thorough elaboration of the support/evidence for the controlling/main idea that includes the effective use of source material. The response clearly and effectively develops ideas, using precise language: • comprehensive evidence (facts and details) from the source material is integrated, relevant, and specific • clear citations or attribution to source material • effective use of a variety of elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is clearly appropriate for the audience and purpose • effective, appropriate style enhances content *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the controlling/main idea **Conventions**: N/A

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3	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has an evident organizational structure and a sense of completeness. Though there may be minor flaws, they do not interfere with the overall coherence. The organization is adequately sustained between and within paragraphs. The response is generally focused: • controlling/main idea of a topic is clear, and the focus is mostly maintained for the purpose and audience • adequate use of transitional strategies with some variety to clarify the relationships between and among ideas • adequate introduction and conclusion • adequate progression of ideas from beginning to end; adequate connections between and among ideas **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides adequate elaboration of the support/evidence for the controlling/main idea that includes the use of source material. The response adequately develops ideas, employing a mix of precise and more general language: • adequate evidence (facts and details) from the source material is integrated and relevant, yet may be general • adequate use of citations or attribution to source material • adequate use of some elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is generally appropriate for the audience and purpose • generally appropriate style is evident *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the controlling/main idea **Conventions**: N/A
2	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has an inconsistent organizational structure. Some flaws are evident, and some ideas may be loosely connected. The organization is somewhat sustained between and within paragraphs. The response may have a minor drift in focus:

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	• controlling/main idea of a topic may be somewhat unclear, or the focus may be insufficiently sustained for the purpose and/or audience • inconsistent use of transitional strategies and/or little variety • introduction or conclusion, if present, may be weak • uneven progression of ideas from beginning to end; and/or formulaic; inconsistent or unclear connections between and among ideas **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides uneven, cursory elaboration of the support/evidence for the controlling/main idea that includes uneven or limited use of source material. The response develops ideas unevenly, using simplistic language: • some evidence (facts and details) from the source material may be weakly integrated, imprecise, repetitive, vague, and/or copied • weak use of citations or attribution to source material • weak or uneven use of elaborative techniques*; • development may consist primarily of source summary • vocabulary use is uneven or somewhat ineffective for the audience and purpose • inconsistent or weak attempt to create appropriate style *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the controlling/main idea **Conventions**: The response demonstrates an adequate command of conventions: • adequate use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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1	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has little or no discernible organizational structure. The response may be related to the topic but may provide little or no focus: • controlling/main idea may be confusing or ambiguous; response may be too brief or the focus may drift from the purpose and/or audience • few or no transitional strategies are evident • introduction and/or conclusion may be missing • frequent extraneous ideas may be evident; ideas may be randomly ordered or have an unclear progression **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides minimal elaboration of the support/evidence for the controlling/main idea that includes little or no use of source material. The response is vague, lacks clarity, or is confusing: • evidence (facts and details) from the source material is minimal, irrelevant, absent, incorrectly used, or predominantly copied • insufficient use of citations or attribution to source material • minimal, if any, use of elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is limited or ineffective for the audience and purpose • little or no evidence of appropriate style *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the controlling/main idea **Conventions**: The response demonstrates a partial command of conventions: • limited use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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0	**Organization/Purpose**: N/A **Evidence/Elaboration**: N/A **Conventions**: The response demonstrates little or no command of conventions: • infrequent use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling **NS (No Score)** **Organization/Purpose**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose **Evidence/Elaboration**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose

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#1 - 182942

Choose the sentence that is punctuated correctly.

A. You will be happy to learn Ms. Smith, that you have won the contest.

B. You will be happy to learn, Ms. Smith that you have won the contest.

C. You, will be happy to learn Ms. Smith, that you have won the contest.

D. You will be happy to learn, Ms. Smith, that you have won the contest.

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A student is writing a description of her school for a pen pal. Read the draft of the description and complete the task that follows.

I am sure that my school is very different from yours. My school is a two-story, brick building. There are classrooms on both floors. On the first floor, in addition to classrooms, there is a gym and a cafeteria. Our library is on the basement floor.

There are about 300 students in my school, which covers kindergarten to grade 5. The younger students are on the first floor. The fourth and fifth grades are on the second floor.

Most of the time we stay at school for our studies and play time, but sometimes we take field trips. These trips are usually fun and interesting.

We have lunch in the cafeteria. You can either buy food or bring a lunch. I usually buy lunch. Sometimes we have pizza. Everyone likes that.

My Field Trips

Trip to apple orchard:

- picked apples
- had apple cider
- learned how apple cider is made

Trip to pumpkin patch:

- went on hayride
- fed hay to horses
- got a pumpkin to take home
- saw beautiful carved pumpkins

Write **one** paragraph that adds more information about the field trips mentioned in the third paragraph.

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#3 - 93185

A student is writing a story for her teacher about a game of kickball. Read the draft of the story and complete the task that follows.

For each underlined pair of words, click on the word that helps readers understand the story.

The sun was beating down, and I could feel the sweat dripping down my neck. It was my turn to kick the ball. My thoughts raced with memories of our last game of kickball. That day, I tried to kick the ball but missed it entirely. I was terribly embarrassed/concerned. I tried to erase that memory from my mind as I stepped up to face the pitcher. Imagine everyone's astonishment/confusion when I kicked the ball so hard that it went right over the playground fence.

#4 - 96054

Choose the sentence that does **not** have errors in grammar usage.

A. She likes neither apples or oranges.

B. You must choose to either stay nor go.

C. The seahorse has neither a stomach nor teeth.

D. This kind of rabbit is usually either brown and white.

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#5 - 182960

Leyla is writing an opinion essay for her principal about organized recess. She wants to revise the draft to create a stronger conclusion. Read the draft paragraph of Leyla's essay, and complete the task that follows.

When we were in earlier grade levels here at Grover Elementary School, we were given free time to play on the playground each day. We enjoyed chatting with our friends, playing on the equipment, and even participating in games of basketball and dodge ball every once in a while. But, when we got to fifth grade, our playground freedom was taken away. Instead of free time, we are now forced to play organized games and sports. Every fifth-grader must play whichever sport or game the teachers choose. This ruins the whole point of recess. We are supposed to have time to relax and recharge. We need time to just enjoy the outdoors with our friends. Now that we no longer have free playground time, more students are getting into trouble for talking during class. That is leading to falling grades.

Choose the sentence that is the **best** conclusion to Leyla's opinion essay.

A. It would be easier for teachers to give us free time than to organize and help us play games.

B. The positive side of having organized games and sports is that students do get more exercise.

C. Until teachers give back our playground freedom, they will continue to see poor student behavior and bad grades.

D. There have even been a couple of students who have fallen asleep in class following organized games and sports.

#6 - 23401

Choose the sentence that is correctly punctuated.

A. Right after, the football game ended, a group of us went out to eat.

B. Jim and I love to swim in the ocean, once we saw a dolphin leap out of the water.

C. Sometimes, when we get bored, we go to the comic book store to look for rare editions.

D. When the movie ended, Mary and Julietta were still laughing they thought the film was hilarious.

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#7 - 23399

A student is writing a narrative for his teacher about receiving a present. The student wants to revise the narrative to take out sentences that do not belong. Read the draft of the narrative and complete the task that follows.

My family gathered in the den waiting for Uncle Ricardo. He lived in Florida and didn't get to visit often. When we did see him, he always had presents for everyone. I was so excited and could hardly wait to see the treasure he had brought me. At last, he burst in the room, his arms loaded with gifts. I was wearing old jeans and a tattered white T-shirt. He handed me a package wrapped in neon-green paper. My heart pounded as I eagerly tore the paper to reveal the words "remote-controlled helicopter." My grandmother beamed with delight when she heard the taxi door slam.

Click on the **two** sentences that do **not** belong in the narrative because they do not follow the order of events in the rest of the narrative.

#8 - 61136 , #9 - 61138 , #10 - 54141 , #11 - 54683 [PT]

Student Directions

Whales Narrative Performance Task

Task:

Your class has been learning about oceans around the world. You and your classmates are most interested in the animals that live in these oceans. Your teacher has asked each of you to pick an ocean animal to research, and you have picked whales. While doing your research, you found a book and two magazine articles about whales.

After you have reviewed these sources, you will answer some questions about them. Briefly skim the sources and the questions that follow. Then, go back and read the sources carefully so you will have the information you will need to answer the questions and complete your research. You may click on the NOTES box to take notes on the information you find in the sources as you read. Your notes will be available to you as you answer the questions.

In Part 2, you will write a story about a topic related to the sources.

Directions for Beginning:
You will now look at three sources. You can go back to any of the sources as often as you like.

Research Questions:
After examining the sources, use the rest of the time in Part 1 to answer the question(s) about them. Your answers to these questions will be scored. Also, your answers will help you think about the information you have reviewed, which should help you write your story.

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You may click on the NOTES button above the sources to look at your notes when you think it would be helpful. Answer the questions in the spaces below them.

Part 1

Sources for Performance Task:

Source #1
Here is an article about whales.

Whales

by Tamra Orr

King of the Sea
Deep under the surface of the ocean, a gentle giant swims through the water. Larger than many of the dinosaurs, the whale is the true king of the sea. Some species grow as long as 100 feet long. They can weigh more than 100 tons! Although there are many different types of whales, and they come in various sizes and colors, their bodies are all quite similar. They use flippers and tails to help push themselves through the water and keep their balance.

On the Surface and Below
Although many people think of whales as fish, they are actually warm-blooded mammals. They need air to breathe, so they have to rise to the surface of water to take a deep breath. Instead of using a nose or mouth, however, whales use a blowhole on the top of their heads. They take in air through the hole and straight into their lungs. They exhale the same way. Once whales take a few breaths, they dive back down, sometimes thousands of feet deep. Many of them can stay underwater for more than an hour before having to come back up and breathe again.

When it comes time to sleep, whales rest near the surface, so they can come to the top and breathe whenever needed. In order to do this, whales do something rather amazing. They only allow one side of their brain to sleep at a time! This way, they are aware of when they need to take another breath!

Whales come to the surface to do more than breathe, however. As big and heavy as they are, many of them jump out of the water. This action is known as breaching. Why do they do it? Even the experts are not sure, but they have a

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number of theories. Many scientists think the mammals do it to shake the barnacles* and other growths off of their skin. Other ideas are that breaching is done to scare away predators or simply because it is a lot of fun!

The Search for Food
Whales live in deep ocean waters across the world. When summer arrives and the water begins to warm up, some species migrate, or move to colder waters in search of more food. How do they keep warm? Whales have built-in coats known as blubber under their skin. Blubber is a thick layer of fat and it not only keeps the mammals warm, but helps them float and gives them extra energy when it is hard to find enough to eat. In the winter, whales migrate to warmer water to have their young.

Whales are incredible creatures that live under the water, but come above it to breathe the air, jump, and play. They truly are the kings of the sea.

*barnacles: small crustaceans that attach themselves to other animals or objects

Sources Used:

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Bio Expedition Publishing (2009). *Facts about Whales*. Retrieved from http://www.whale-world.com/facts-about-whales.html

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Whale breach, 2013. Courtesy of National Oceanic and Atmospheric Association.

Source #2
This article from *Click* magazine is about what life is like for whales living in the ocean.

Swimming with the Pod

by Catherine Ripley

PFFFFF! Splash! A six-year-old male orca whale surfaces, shooting a big spray of stale air from the blowhole on top of his head. For several minutes he and his family slice slowly through the ocean waves, breathing deeply, filling their large lungs with air. Then, side by side, the orcas dive.

The male is the youngest and swims close to his mom. To their left is his uncle and in front, leading them all, is his grandmother. A second uncle swims nearby. And just beyond him are two more families in the pod, which is the name for a group of whales. The 16 whales in this pod live together in Johnstone Strait, on the northwest coast of Canada.

Most orcas stay with the pod they are born into for their whole lives. As an

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infant, the young male swam beneath his mother's belly, where he was safe and could nurse easily. When he was born, his mother probably helped him to the surface to take his first breath. Whales need air, just like people, or they will drown. Sometimes the pod might even help an injured whale come up to the surface for air.

When orcas are not searching for food, they like to "talk" and socialize—even play! They roll and splash in the salty water, and they call to each other. Scr-eee-CH! Whistle! Whistle!

The young male spy hops. He punches his head and upper body above the water and looks around. He sees a female cousin breach the waves. She throws her body almost completely out of the water and crashes down again. KERSPLASH! Another cousin swims sideways and smacks her flipper playfully against the water. SLAP!

Now Grandmother is speeding toward shore and the family follows. She rubs her massive body through the smooth rounded rocks on the bottom of the bay. Mom goes next and the young male follows. The family spends the next hour "beach rubbing." Scientists think this feels good to orcas and may help keep their skin clean.

But most of the pod's day is spent finding food. The whales spread out and send out a series of fast clicks as they swim down the bay together. Click, click, click! The orcas can tell from the way their clicks echo through the water if a school of salmon is nearby!

Some orcas hunt seals, sea lions, and porpoises, instead of fish. They live in small groups and are silent when they hunt. No chatting allowed! Their prey might be listening!

But the young male's pod eats mainly salmon. The whales use many calls to stay in touch as they hunt. "Wee-oo-uuo," cries a cousin from across the bay. "Wee-oo-uuo," answers Grandmother. "Squ-eee-AL, CRe-e-e-eak," calls Mom. Each pod "speaks" slightly differently from the next, and scientists can recognize a particular pod by the sounds its whales make.

Soon the orcas' bellies are tight with salmon. It is time for a rest. Orcas cannot sleep under the water. They must come to the surface every few minutes to breathe. So they cruise slowly forward, diving, then surfacing for air, in a regular resting pattern that can last for hours. Swimming together, the young whale and his family surface, breathe, and dive ... surface, breathe, and dive... ZZZZZZ!

"Swimming with the Pod" by Catherine Ripley, from *Click*. Copyright © 2007 by Epals Media. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company.

Source #3

This article from *Highlights for Children* magazine is about ways that whales get food in the ocean.

How Humpbacks Go Fishing

by Linda Brown Anderson

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Humpback whales are known for feeding alone or in pairs. Most of the time, they plow through the ocean with their huge mouths open, scooping up thousands of tiny shrimp-like creatures called krill.

But humpbacks that live near the west coast of North America have a surprising and spectacular way of catching fish. When they spot a school of herring, the humpbacks dive into the depths and close in on the fish from below. A steady flow of bubbles rises to the surface, forming a circle.

Suddenly, all of the whales explode out of the water at once, right in the middle of the bubble-circle. Their huge mouths are open and full of silver, wriggling fish.

Scientists wanted to know more about how the whales fed on schools of fish. Using underwater microphones, they listened to humpbacks as they fed. The whales made magnificent trumpet-like sounds as they swept up and ate the fish.

The researchers also used the Critter cam, a video camera that can be attached harmlessly to the back of a whale. It showed that the whales waved their huge flippers back and forth as they fed.

Most researchers thought the humpbacks were fighting over the fish. Whales are known to use bubbles and loud calls when they try to chase away other whales. Maybe they also waved their flippers to shoo one another away.

Humpback whales blowing bubbles

A Deep Mystery

Dr. Fred Sharpe had a radical idea for the late 1980s, when he began his research. Maybe the whales were working together!

Dr. Sharpe led a team of researchers. They used sonar to "see" deeper into the water. A sonar device sends out sound waves, then catches the echoes of those waves after they bounce off objects, such as whales, fish, and bubbles. Using the echoes, the sonar creates pictures of the objects.

The sonar showed that, to a humpback, bubbles are tools. A single whale swims below the fish, carefully releasing air from its blowhole to create a wall of bubbles.

Also using sonar, the scientists saw other whales moving toward the herring, chasing the fish toward the bubble wall. The herring were reluctant to try to escape through the bubbles. The bubble-blowing whale began to swim in a circle, making the wall of bubbles go all the way around the fish. The fish were trapped in a bubble net!

Using an underwater microphone, the research team recorded the sounds of the whales. The whales swam under the herring and began their trumpet-like calls.

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Then the whales swam upward all at once, waving their flippers, and gulped a large number of fish.

The whales were working together!

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#8 - 61136

Explain why whales use different types of sounds. Give **two** reasons, using information from two different sources. Be sure to give the title or number of the sources you use.

#9 - 61138

All three sources describe how whales behave. Choose **two** details below that can be found in more than one of the sources.

A. Whales migrate in summer and winter.

B. Whales breathe air through a blowhole.

C. Whales do beach rubbing to clean their skin.

D. Whales stay with their pods their whole lives.

E. Whales move to warm water to have their young.

F. Whales rest on or near the surface of the water.

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#10 - 54141

Explain how whales work together to help each other. Give **one** detail from Source #2 and **one** detail from Source #3 to support your explanation. For each detail, identify the source title or number.

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Student Directions for Part 2

You will now review your notes and sources, plan, draft, revise, and edit your story. You may use your notes and refer to the sources. Now read your assignment and the information about how your story will be scored; then begin your work.

Your assignment:

Your class is making a storybook about adventures in the ocean to finish your Oceans Around the World unit. You will write a story to contribute to the class storybook. You have decided to write a story about a family that goes on vacation to a place right by the ocean. They go out on a boat ride and spot a huge creature coming out of the water. It's a whale! Tell the story of what happens when the family sees the whale.

Your story will be read by your teacher and the other students in your class. When writing your story, find ways to use information and details from the sources to improve your story. Make sure you develop your character(s), the setting, and the plot, using details, dialogue, and description.

REMEMBER: A well-written story:

- has a clear plot and clear sequence of events
- is well-organized and has a point of view
- uses details from the sources to support your story
- uses clear language
- follows rules of writing (spelling, punctuation, and grammar)

Now begin work on your story. Manage your time carefully so that you can:

1.
plan your story

2.
write your story

3.
revise and edit the final draft of your story

Word-processing tools and spell check are available to you.

For Part 2, you are being asked to write a story that is several paragraphs long. Type your response in the box below. The box will get bigger as you type.

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Remember to check your notes and your prewriting/planning as you write and then revise and edit your story.

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#12 - 182951

Edit the sentences by clicking on the sentence that does **not** use verb tense correctly.

Mia asked her sister, “Have you seen my new book? I set it right here on the counter after school.”

“Mia, I have not seen your book, but I believe that you probably put it somewhere and forgot about it,” her sister explained.

Mia frowned and replied, “If I had put my book somewhere else, I would not have forget it!”

#13 - 26451

David is writing a description of his mom's office for his class. Read the draft paragraph of the description and complete the task that follows.

My mom, Linda, works at a bank. Last week, I had a day off from school, and I got to visit her at work. When I arrived, my mom led me to her office in the back of the bank. She showed me her big, comfortable desk chair that twists and turns and slides across the floor. I sat in it and pretended to answer the phone like I was an important banker. I asked her what kind of work she does, <u>but</u>/<u>so</u> she pulled up a file on her computer and let me take a look. It was columns and columns of numbers that made my head spin. I couldn't believe she understood it all. It seemed like hard work to me. After that, my mom said I could go to the lobby and read a magazine while she worked a little longer. <u>Instead</u>/<u>Therefore</u>, I chose to stay in her office to learn more about her job.

For each pair of underlined words, click on the word that helps readers understand the description.

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#14 - 22835

A student is writing a report for the school newsletter about the school talent show. Read the draft of the report and complete the task that follows.

The talent show began as usual with the host announcing a series of acts. The students enjoyed watching juggling, dancing, and piano playing. After the third act, the audience was clapping politely. Then, the lights in the auditorium went out and the crowd was plunged into darkness. Moments later, an amazing light and sound show started. Several students wearing glow-in-the-dark outfits began doing flips and cartwheels. Everyone leapt up and cheered. The most exciting and unexpected act was a great ending for the show.

Choose **two** more exact words that the student could use in place of the underlined word.

A. After

B. Finally

C. So

D. Suddenly

E. Surprisingly

F. Unfortunately

#15 - 26831

A student is writing a narrative for her teacher about a dessert. Read a part of the narrative and complete the task that follows.

Sean leaned back in his chair and gazed on his creation with awe and wonder. The crayon-colored balls of cold, creamy delight melted gently. The whipped cream was piled high. The sprinkled nuts looked like freckles on the face of the sundae. Sean was certain this was the best ice-cream treat he had ever constructed.

Choose **two** of the following descriptions that would **best** replace was piled high.

A. looked delicious and tasty

B. was more than he usually used

C. sat on the ice cream in a large amount

D. was added on top of the ice-cream scoops

E. topped the dessert like bright white party hats

F. was piled on the ice cream like snow on mountaintops

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#16 - 41674

A student is writing a formal letter to his principal about recycling at his school. Read the draft of the letter and complete the task that follows.

Dear Principal Martinez,

I have always been proud to see our school's bright green recycling bins in my classrooms, the cafeteria, and our media center. We recycle many pounds of paper and plastic each week. I know this helps our environment and saves money for the school at the same time. That is why I am so <u>sad</u> about your decision to not allow the recycling club to post recycling signs around the school. I am writing to ask your permission to allow this. These posters and signs will <u>hint</u> teachers and students to recycle. The recycling club empties bins every other day, so no one has to worry about anything extra! I hope you will consider my suggestion and allow the recycling club to post these signs around the school.

Sincerely,

Thomas H.

Choose the **two most** exact ways to say what the writer means by the underlined words.

A. mad/get

B. upset/tell

C. unhappy/ask

D. bummed /force

E. disappointed/remind

F. surprised/encourage

#17 - 23403

A student wrote a paragraph that contains some errors. Read the paragraph and complete the task that follows.

Last week, our class had a surprise. We had just settled in our seats when someone new walked through the door. He introduced himself as our new homeroom teacher Mr. Johnson. He asked us to say our names and one thing about ourselves. After that, he passed out copies of a story he likes called The Good Game. He said he wanted us to read it and talk about it during the next homeroom.

Click on the **two** sentences that contain errors in punctuation or grammar usage.

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Student Directions

Service Animals Opinion Performance Task

Task:
A person with a disability visited your class today to discuss how his trained service animal allows him to enjoy more independence and participate more fully in everyday activities. You and your classmates became interested in learning more about service animals. Your teacher took your class to the school library to look up more information about this topic. You have found three articles about service animals.

After you have reviewed these sources, you will answer some questions about them. Briefly scan the sources and the questions that follow. Then, go back and read the sources carefully so you will have the information you will need to answer the questions and complete your research. You may click on the Global Notes button to take notes on the information you find in the sources as you read. You may also use scratch paper to take notes.

In Part 2, you will write an opinion paper using information you have read.

Directions for Beginning:

You will now review several sources. You can review any of the sources as often as you like.

Research Questions:

After reviewing the research sources, use the rest of the time in Part 1 to answer question(s) about them. Your answers to these questions will be scored. Also, your answers will help you think about the information you have read and viewed, which should help you write your opinion paper.

You may click on the Global Notes button or refer back to your scratch paper to look at your notes when you think it would be helpful. Answer the questions in the spaces below the items.

Both the Global Notes on the computer and your written notes on scratch paper will be available to you in Part 1 and Part 2 of the performance task.

Part 1

Sources for Performance Task:

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Source #1
You have found a current article about capuchin monkeys on a website about service animals. The author is a veterinarian who writes articles for educational publications.

Monkey Helpers

by Tamra Orr

An Unusual Set of Helping Hands

Every day people make countless moves that they tend to take for granted. They scratch their noses and pull on their backpacks. People grab something to eat and push up their glasses. They flip the pages of their textbooks and turn off their lights. For people living with injuries to the spinal cord, however, these basic movements are very difficult. For some, they are even impossible. For the past 35 years, more than 160 people with injuries to the spinal cord have found support from a very unusual set of helping hands: those of specially trained capuchin monkeys.

Capuchin monkeys are very small. Some weigh less than eight pounds, even when fully grown. They are also extremely smart. In the wild, they have shown the ability to pick up tools and use them to solve problems. Their hands can easily carry small tools. This makes it easier for them to handle modern items such as remotes and cell phones.

Although capuchin monkeys are smart and are able to handle small tools, not all types of monkeys are ideal to use as service animals. Some monkeys, such as howler monkeys, are too large or strong. Monkeys who have not been properly trained are also unreliable. They might behave in ways that are hard to predict. For example, a monkey could suddenly hurt a person if it got angry or frightened for some reason.

While some people believe capuchin monkeys are wonderful service animals, not everyone agrees. Capuchins are small, easy to train, and able to bond, or form close relationships, with humans. However, they are still, in the end, wild animals. April Truitt, director of the Primate Rescue Center in Kentucky, says that having a wild animal in your home may put both the animal and the owner at increased risk of getting injured. She points out that it is possible for capuchins to become violent suddenly and this can be a danger to their owners and others.

Long Before School Starts

Long before capuchin monkeys begin their training, they have already spent years around humans. Born in a Massachusetts zoo, they must live with foster families as long as twelve years before beginning their training on how to assist a person with a disability. During this time, they are taught how to share a house with humans. They get used to being around pets. They even learn basic tasks like how to take baths. This requires a great deal of time and effort.

Learning to Help

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Capuchin monkeys learn how to assist people with disabilities at Helping Hands, otherwise known as the monkey college, in Boston, Massachusetts. This college is not quite like going to a traditional school. Every day, for three to five years, capuchin monkeys learn new skills. Their lessons do not focus on reading and writing though. Days are spent learning how to load a DVD into a player and push play, or how to open and close microwave doors. This education takes time, patience, and money. The cost of educating just one monkey is close to $40,000. Finally, after up to five years of training, the animals finish school. Now the monkeys are ready to go and live with someone who needs them to help make life a little bit easier.

The Simple Things

Having a capuchin monkey in the house is not the same as having a dog or cat. Because of their training and their intelligence, these monkeys are able to do an amazing number of chores for the person who is disabled and cannot do them alone. Along with operating microwaves and DVD players, these service animals can also turn lights off and on for their new owners. They can open bottles and flip the pages of a book for their owner. They can even reach out and scratch an annoying itch.

Every year, Helping Hands places dozens of monkeys in homes of people with disabilities. The monkeys take good care of their owners. In return, the owners feel safer and more able to do tasks that so many others take for granted.

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DiBlasio, N. (2013, July 4). Monkey see. Monkey do. USA Weekend. Retrieved from: http://www.usaweekend.com/article/20130705/HEALTH/307050007/Graduates-of-Monkey-College-give-their-companions-a-sense-of-purpose

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Source #2
You found an article about service animals in a 2002 issue of *Click*, a magazine for children.

Animals Helping People

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A monkey who helps you drink out of a straw? A dog that opens the refrigerator door when you want a snack? A pony gentle enough to ride even if you cannot see? When people need extra care, special animals are there to help!

Seeing Eye dogs are trained to be the eyes for people who cannot see. All over the world, Seeing Eye dogs are hard at work—guiding, protecting, and loving their blind masters.

Horseback riding is good exercise. It also helps people feel happy and confident. Even riders who cannot see, or who have trouble moving their muscles, can have fun on a quiet, gentle, well-trained horse.

Hearing dogs help people who are deaf or hard-of-hearing. These smart, friendly, energetic dogs are specially trained to let their owners know when the doorbell rings, the smoke alarm goes off, or the baby wakes up from a nap.

This boy needs both his hands and all his energy just to walk. Luckily, his assistance dog is there to carry his backpack. Assistance dogs are good helpers —and good friends!

An assistance dog is trained to help

. . . Assistance animals like this capuchin monkey are smart and nimble enough to help in lots of ways—they can turn the lights on and off, play a CD, or get their owners a cool drink!

A capuchin monkey helps with many tasks

This girl is part of a special program to help children with serious physical and learning difficulties. Swimming with dolphins helps the children relax—and who wouldn't love being around such wild and beautiful creatures!

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Dolphins are calming creatures

Animals helping people. *Click*, *5*(9), 21-23.

Source #3
This article from a magazine about animal rights describes new service animal rules that are included as part of a federal law. The author is on staff at the magazine and has a legal background.

New Service Animal Rules
by Clare Mishica

New rules regarding service animals were added to the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) in March 2011. The ADA is a law that protects the rights of people with disabilities.

The new rules limit the kind of service animals that people with disabilities can have in public places. Now, only dogs and miniature horses are allowed in public places. The changes were meant to clear up confusion regarding service animals in public places. Business owners were unclear about the kind of service animals that were allowed in their businesses. They were also unclear about the amount of responsibility that they had for service animals that were brought into their businesses.

A man has a large snake draped over his shoulders. He wants to enter a café for lunch and says the snake is a service animal that helps and comforts him. In the past, the law would have required the café to allow the man to bring his snake inside. This was because people were allowed to choose any service animal as helpers, including pigs, birds, and lizards! Before the new rule, any type of animal could have been considered a service animal. As long as the owner felt that the animal provided him/her assistance, then any type of animal could be used as a service animal. Once the new rules went into effect, the only service animals permitted in public places are dogs and miniature horses.

What Made the Changes Necessary?
The changes were needed to protect people from diseases. Different animals carry certain diseases. When animals go into public places, they might pass illnesses to humans. In addition, some animals are not trained to keep an area clean. For example, birds could leave droppings on a store floor. This creates an unhealthy setting for others.

Second, the law was changed to help business owners. In the past, businesses such as hotels had to accept all types of service animals, and that could create problems. For example, some animals are large or noisy. Others might cause

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damage or have special needs. Dogs and miniature horses, however, are tame. They have been used as pets for hundreds of years. They listen to commands. Both dogs and miniature horses are trained to guide the blind. These animals can be trusted by pet owners and business owners.

Some people prefer to use service animals other than dogs and miniature horses and this is still possible. The new rules limit only the kind of service animals permitted in public places. In private, people are able to choose other animals. Some people with disabilities use monkeys to help them do tasks in their homes. These monkeys have similar hand and finger control to humans, so they can perform more tasks than other animals.

Would you like to learn more about the federal rules for service animals? You can visit the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) website. It gives details and reasons for changes in the rules.

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#18 - 182646

Click on the boxes to match each source with the idea or ideas that it supports. Some ideas may have more than one source selected.

	Source #1: Monkey Helpers	**Source #2: Animals Helping People**	**Source #3: New Service Animal Rules**
People who own businesses have to consider the well-being of all of their guests.			
Being smart and able to handle small objects makes certain animals more appropriate than other animals to assist people who have a disability.			

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#19 - 182648

Which source would **most likely** be the most helpful in understanding how a service animal is trained? Explain why this source is **most likely** the most helpful. Give at least **two** details from the source to support your answer.

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Student Directions

Service Animals Opinion Performance Task

Part 2
You will now review your notes and sources, and plan, draft, revise, and edit your writing. You may use your notes and go back to the sources. Now read your assignment and the information about how your writing will be scored; then begin your work.

Your Assignment:
When your class returns from the library, your classmates begin to share what they learned about different types of service animals. They also begin to discuss the new rule that allows only dogs and miniature horses as service animals in public places. Some students agree with the rule, and some students disagree with the rule. Your teacher asks you to write a paper explaining your opinion about the new rule.

In your paper, you will take a side as to whether you agree with the rule allowing only service dogs and miniature horses in public places, or whether you disagree with the rule. Your paper will be read by your teacher and your classmates. Make sure you clearly state your opinion and write several paragraphs supporting your opinion with reasons and details from the sources. Develop your ideas clearly and use your own words, except when quoting directly from the sources. Be sure to give the source title or number for the details or facts you use.

REMEMBER: A well-written opinion paper

- has a clear opinion.
- is well-organized and stays on the topic.
- has an introduction and conclusion.
- uses transitions.
- uses details or facts from the sources to support your opinion.
- puts the information from the sources in your own words, except when using direct quotations from the sources.
- gives the title or number of the source for the details or facts you included.
- develops ideas clearly.
- uses clear language.
- follows rules of writing (spelling, punctuation, and grammar usage).

Now begin work on your opinion paper. Manage your time carefully so that you can

1. plan your opinion paper.
2. write your opinion paper.

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3. revise and edit the final draft of your opinion paper.

Word-processing tools and spell check are available to you.

For Part 2, you are being asked to write an opinion paper that is several paragraphs long. Type your response in the box below. The box will get bigger as you type.

Remember to check your notes and your prewriting/planning as you write and then revise and edit your opinion paper.

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#21 - 26827

A student is writing an article for her school newsletter about the book fair. Read the draft of the newsletter article and complete the task that follows.

Our school book fair begins next Monday! Come before, during, or after school to find the perfect fantasy to carry your imagination away deep into space or across a strange land. Or perhaps you will find a true story that brings history to life. Whatever your taste in reading, we have <u>stuff</u> for you!

Choose the **best** word or phrase to replace the underlined word to make the writer's meaning more clear.

A. books

B. good things

C. some reading material

D. a novel, tale, or nonfiction saga

#22 - 182958

A student is writing a report about quilting for social studies. Read the two paragraphs from the draft of the report and complete the task that follows.

Click on the **two** sentences in the paragraphs that do **not** support the main idea.

When it gets cold at night, you might reach for a quilt to keep you warm. Many quilts today are produced in factories, but some people enjoy sewing their own quilts. Some people like blankets better than quilts. Making a quilt can mean more than just making something to keep people warm; it can be a way of preserving memories. Today's quilt might be made from pieces of a worn-out football jersey or a baby's first blanket. Similarly, quilts made in the past were made from scraps of cloth or pieces of old clothing.

Long ago, people would organize parties called "quilting bees." At a quilting bee, individuals would share stories while they sewed their pieces of fabric together. By working together, these quilters could create a quilt more quickly than if each quilter were working alone. Sometimes, they had to quit early because they ran out of candles. Swapping stories helped pass the time and provided some entertainment. Today, people still enjoy quilting with friends.

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#23 - 41664

A student is writing a formal letter to her principal about a school dance. Read the draft of the letter and answer the question that follows.

Dear Ms. Lane,

I was very upset to hear that the fifth grade dance will be canceled this year. This idea <u>is not fair</u>. Students in the fifth grade have been waiting for their turn to have a dance for years. Some of us have watched our older brothers and sisters get dressed up for the dance. We love to hear the stories about how much fun they had and how delicious the food was. All of the fifth grade students I know agree with my position. I hope you will reconsider your decision.

Sincerely,

Zoe Hughes

Which more exact phrase **best** replaces the underlined phrase?

A. seems like a bad and terrible thing to do

B. is unreasonable for you to make a decision about

C. takes a special tradition away from students for no reason

D. makes you seem like you do not care about the right thing to do

#24 - 35762

A student is writing a narrative for her teacher about a boat ride. Read this part of the narrative and complete the task that follows.

I had never been on a boat in the ocean before and did not know what to expect. My stomach gave a little lurch as I watched the shoreline fade into nothingness behind us. Luckily, the waves <u>were pretty calm for the boat</u>.

Which of the following descriptive phrases would **best** replace <u>were pretty calm for the boat</u>?

A. moved us along in the water

B. did not treat the boat roughly

C. carried the boat as gently as a rocking chair

D. moved along without causing a problem for the boat

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#25 - 26465

Choose the sentence in which the title of the author's work is correctly shown.

A. Frank's favorite book is *The Lightning Thief* by Rick Riordan.

B. Ms. Johnson's favorite poem is The Road not Taken by Robert Frost.

C. My sisters want to see "Little Women," a play adapted from the book by Louisa May Alcott.

D. I am reading **The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County**, a short story by Mark Twain.

#26 - 123746

A student is writing a narrative for language arts class about achieving a personal goal. The student wants to revise the draft to improve the development. Read the draft of the narrative and complete the task that follows.

My personal goal for the month of September was to help out more around the house. I wanted to show my parents that I could be responsible and help without needing to be asked first. I knew there were plenty of chores to do like taking out the garbage, feeding the dog, and cleaning the kitchen. When I started working around the house without being asked, I could tell my parents were surprised.

“Jake,” my dad said, “your mother and I are very proud of you for helping out around the house.”

“Thanks, Dad,” I responded. I was proud of myself. I felt like I was growing up!

“Jake, come downstairs!” my dad yelled one day when he got home from work. “We have a surprise for you!”

<u>I ran downstairs and looked outside. A dirt bike!</u>

I could hardly believe what I was seeing. I blinked my eyes and pinched myself to make sure I wasn’t dreaming.

The writer wants to add dialogue to the story to make it more descriptive. Which of the following sentences would be **best** to come after the underlined text to show how Jake feels about getting a new dirt bike?

A. “Can I ride it in the street?”

B. “Oh no! It’s the wrong color!”

C. “Do I have to share this with my younger brother?”

D. “This is the dirt bike I’ve been wanting for years!”

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Student Directions

Ready for a Nap Informational Performance Task

Task:
Your school is preparing for an assembly to celebrate Earth Day. As part of the assembly, each class is responsible for setting up an exhibit about different aspects of nature. Your class has been assigned the theme "Unusual Animal Behaviors." As part of the project, you have decided to learn more about hibernation. You decide to do some research, and you find three sources about hibernation.

After you have reviewed these sources, you will answer some questions about them. Briefly skim the sources and the questions that follow. Then, go back and read the sources carefully so you will have the information you will need to answer the questions and complete your research. You may click on the Global Notes button to take notes on the information you find in the sources as you read. You may also use scratch paper to take notes.

In Part 2, you will write an informational article using information you have read.

Directions for Beginning:
You will now review several sources. You can review any of the sources as often as you like.

Research Questions:
After reviewing the sources, use the rest of the time in Part 1 to answer question(s) about them. Your answers to these questions will be scored. Also, your answers will help you think about the information you have read and viewed, which should help you write your informational article.

You may click on the Global Notes button or refer back to your scratch paper to review your notes when you think it would be helpful. Answer the questions in the spaces below the items.

Both the Global Notes on the computer and your written notes on scratch paper will be available to you in Part 1 and Part 2 of the performance task.

Part 1

Sources for Performance Task:

Source #1
This article from *Cricket* magazine explains how animal hibernation works.

Do Not Disturb: The Mysteries of Animal Hibernation
by Margery Facklam

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A 300-pound grizzly bear shuffled through a dry autumn meadow in Yellowstone National Park. She stopped to catch a mouse with one swat of her huge paw and then ambled on toward a clear stream. At the water's edge, she stood on her hind legs to sniff the air before she plunged into the cold water. In a moment she caught a salmon with a swoop of her paw and gulped it down. She devoured two more fish before she waded out and shook the water from her thick, gray-tipped, "grizzled" fur.

Day after day the grizzly loped through the meadows in search of insects, berries, and small rodents. . . . Food seemed to be the only thing on her mind.

But as she grew fatter and the air grew colder, she began to search for something else—her winter den. When she found a place that suited her, on a steep north-facing slope at the base of a large fir tree, she started to dig. It was a tight fit as she tunneled under the tree roots that would make a strong roof for her den, but she needed room enough only to squeeze through to her bedroom. In the spring, after four or five months of a deep sleep called hibernation, she would be much thinner.

Late in November, when the temperature had dropped below freezing, the big grizzly no longer raced across the open meadow. Day after day she acted as though she were walking in her sleep. Then one day, when the wind whipped the snow in swirls around her, the bear crawled into her den.

All night it snowed, covering the opening to her tunnel. No one would be able to find it. The grizzly was safe for the winter, cozy and warm beneath the blanket of snow. She would not eat [or] drink water, . . . until spring. Her heart rate would slow down from its usual 40 or 50 beats a minute to 10 or 12. Her temperature would drop a few degrees, and she would breathe slowly, just as a person in a deep sleep would do.

How does hibernation work? How can animals go without food and water for many months without starving to death? What tells them it's time to enter the den? And then how do they know it's time to wake up? . . .

Hibernation is a way for animals to save energy and survive through the winter when food is hard to find. (Hiberna is a Latin word that means winter.) It is controlled by a part of the brain called the hypothalamus (hi-po-thal-a-mus), which also regulates hunger, thirst, and blood pressure.

In one experiment to find out how hibernation works, a biologist [scientist] took a small amount of blood from hibernating ground squirrels. He froze the blood. In spring, he defrosted it and injected it into a different group of ground squirrels who had been running around. Not long after, the energetic ground squirrels curled up and began to hibernate.

Scientists have found in the blood of hibernating animals a substance they call HIT, which stands for hibernation inducement[1] trigger. Although they do not know exactly what this . . . is, they have learned that this trigger goes into action when one of three things happens: when the days become shorter and there is less light, when there are big changes in temperature (either extreme cold or heat), or when food is scarce.

There are different levels of hibernation. The animals known as the "real" hibernators, such as woodchucks and ground squirrels, sleep so deeply that they are almost impossible to wake up. . . . During hibernation, the woodchuck's heart slows from beating 80 times a minute to only 4 or 5. Its normal body temperature of 100 degrees Fahrenheit drops to 45 or 50 degrees.

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But even so, every few weeks the woodchuck gets up to nibble on food and use the small toilet room in its underground burrow. . . .

The in-between hibernators really take only long winter naps. Skunks, raccoons, and a few others lower their body temperature a couple of degrees and breathe more slowly, but they wake up to forage [search] for food between winter storms.

In order to survive weeks or months without food, most hibernating animals go on an eating binge in late summer and early fall. The fat they build up supplies energy and keeps them warm while they sleep. But along with this regular white fat, hibernating mammals have patches of special brown fat across their shoulders and back. The brown fat works like a fast food restaurant; it delivers quick energy whenever it is needed.

A hibernating animal must warm up before it can wake up, and its brain has to warm up first in order to send messages to the rest of the body to get moving. In its handy location across the shoulders and back, the brown fat is close to the hibernating mammal's brain, heart, and lungs, which must get the first spurt of energy as hibernation comes to an end.

Whether a groundhog sound asleep in its burrow or a grizzly wintering in a cozy den—each hibernating animal follows the built-in pattern of its species to survive the cycle of the seasons. Hibernation is an amazing way for some animals to protect themselves until food and warmth reappear in spring.

[1]inducement: something that gives you a reason for doing something

Do Not Disturb: The Mysteries of Animal Hibernation by Margery Facklam. Copyright © 1990 by Carus Publishing Company. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company.

Source #2
This article from *Time for Kids* magazine provides information about a study that answers the question: Do bears hibernate?

Do Bears Hibernate?

We think that bears hibernate. They disappear into dens for months at a time and come out in the spring looking skinny. But hibernation is difficult to study, because bears that live in zoos do not follow their natural sleeping and eating cycles.

Now, a report in the journal *Science* suggests that bears do truly hibernate. Scientists from the University of Alaska at Fairbanks worked with five American black bears. Sensors were put inside the bears. The animals were then sent to live in fake dens. . . . In November, the bears settled in for a long sleep. Scientists watched them on video cameras and monitored their vital signs.[1] The bears almost always slept in a curled position. They moved around once or twice a day. Their body temperature dropped, as did the rate at which their bodies burned calories.

The findings could help scientists learn how to create healthy hibernation in humans. This could someday be used for long-distance space travel, when a long-lasting, deep sleep would help during the journey.

[1]vital signs: important things a body does that can be measured to check

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health—such as breathing and heart rate

Do Bears Hibernate? Copyright © 2011 by Time Inc. Reprinted by permission of Time Inc.

Source #3
This article from *Highlights for Children* magazine talks about a scientist that studies hibernating bears.

A Barn for Bears
by Andy Boyles

Dr. Michael Vaughan has a barn for bears. On a wooded mountain near Blacksburg, Virginia, the low barn sits under the trees.

In November the air inside is cold, which is just right for bears. . . .

They are preparing to enter the remarkable sleeplike state called hibernation.

Dr. Vaughan and his students study the bears before, during, and after hibernation. In the spring, they release the bears.

This research has been going on for more than ten years, ever since Dr. Vaughan began working at Virginia Tech University. "The chance to work with these big animals was just too good to pass up," he says.

Winter "Sleep"
. . . In the fall, a bear fattens up on acorns and other high-fat foods. As winter sets in, the bear usually chooses a snug den, such as a dry space under a big rock.

The bear curls up on a bed it has made of leaves and brush. Its heart slows down, and its body temperature drops. The bear does not really sleep all winter. But as long as the bear is not disturbed, it does not leave its den for the next three to five months—not to eat, not even to eliminate wastes from its body.

Female bears always have their cubs, usually two or three of them, in the middle of winter. The mother curls around her sightless, helpless young to keep them warm and to nurse them. (When the cubs are born, they weigh about half a pound. By spring, they are big enough to leave the den with their mother.)

Because hibernation keeps each bear in one place, winter is a good time for scientists to find and study bears. But if researchers disturb a hibernating bear too often, it may leave and spend valuable energy searching for another den.

That's one reason Dr. Vaughan keeps bears in a barn. Researchers can study each of them once every ten days. . . .

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#27 - 103996

Source #1 and Source #3 discuss bears hibernating. Explain what the sources say about bears hibernating. Use **two** details, one detail from Source #1 and one detail from Source #3, to support your explanation. For each detail, include the source title or number.

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#28 - 103998

Which source has the most useful information about how hibernation works? Explain why this source has the most useful information about how hibernation works. Give at least **two** details from the source to support your answer.

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Student Directions

Ready for a Nap Informational Performance Task

Part 2

You will now review your notes and sources, and plan, draft, revise, and edit your writing. You may use your notes and go back to the sources. Now read your assignment and the information about how your writing will be scored; then begin your work.

Your Assignment:
Your class has been learning about unusual animal behaviors in preparation for your school's Earth Day assembly. As part of your class's exhibit, you will write an informational article about hibernation. Your article will be read by other students, teachers, and parents who attend the Earth Day assembly.

Using more than one source, develop a main idea about hibernation. Choose the most important information from more than one source to support your main idea. Then, write an informational article that is several paragraphs long. Clearly organize your article and support your main idea with details from the sources. Use your own words except when quoting directly from the sources. Be sure to give the source title or number when using details from the sources.

REMEMBER: A well-written informational article

• has a clear main idea.
• is well-organized and stays on the topic.
• has an introduction and a conclusion.
• uses transitions.
• uses details from the sources to support your main idea.
• puts the information from the sources in your own words, except when using direct quotations from the sources.
• gives the title or number of the source for the details or facts you included.
• develops ideas clearly.
• uses clear language.
• follows rules of writing (spelling, punctuation, and grammar usage).

Now begin work on your informational article. Manage your time carefully so that you can

1. plan your informational article.
2. write your informational article.
3. revise and edit the final draft of your informational article.

Word-processing tools and spell check are available to you.

For Part 2, you are being asked to write an informational article that is several paragraphs long. Type your response in the box below. The box will get bigger as you type.

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Remember to check your notes and your prewriting/planning as you write and then revise and edit your informational article.

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#30 - 182938

A student is writing an essay for school about her favorite meal. Read the paragraph from the essay and complete the task that follows.

My grandmother would cook supper for us every Saturday night. Even though it was always the same meal, my whole family agreed that it was the best food we had ever tasted. We would have good fried chicken, creamy mashed potatoes, juicy green peas, soft cornbread, and nice apple pie with vanilla ice cream.

Choose the **two** pairs of more exact words the student could use in place of the underlined words.

A. strong, sour

B. neat, plain

C. crispy, tasty

D. much, better

E. ordinary, fine

F. delicious, sweet

#31 - 60337

A student is writing a story for her teacher about doing chores at home. Read the draft of the story and answer the question that follows.

I was just about to go and get myself a cold, refreshing drink when my mother called for me to come and clean my room. I knew it was no use to make up some lame excuse and try to get out of it. If I wanted to have any time to myself today, I just had to suck it up and get it done.

Which more exact word **best** replaces the underlined word?

A. bouquet

B. cocoon

C. soda

D. glacier

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#32 - 22779

A student is writing a report for class. Read the paragraph from the report and complete the task that follows.

The student wants to replace the words “got” and “land” with more specific words. After each of these words is a word pair. Click on the word that is the **best** replacement for the word in quotes.

Amelia Earhart was born on July 24, 1897. She saw her first airplane when she was 10 years old, and she took her first plane ride in 1920. After that first airplane ride, Amelia wanted to become a pilot. There were not many female pilots back then, but that did not stop the young woman. She borrowed money from her mother and took flying lessons. She got obtained/achieved her pilot's license in 1921. In 1932, she became the first woman to make a solo flight across the Atlantic Ocean. Because of this, she was one of the most famous people in the land country/place. Amelia Earhart inspired other women to follow their dreams.

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